circles, a decision was to be taken on whether these railways were to be company or state managed. Since various vested interests were involved, inevitably, the Committee was divided between the advocates of company management and the champions of State management.

When the time came for the final report to be drawn up, the three members from England, including the Chairman, favoured State management. The other members, who had a vested interest in various Indian railways, favoured company management. At the end of the deliberations, Acworth declared that the Committee was equally divided with four members favouring company management, and four in favour of State management. As Chairman, Acworth had the right to give his casting vote, which he did—in favour of State management. Purshotamdas too had voted for State management. There is an interesting aside to this which testifies to Purshotamdas's high intention and unimpeachable integrity. One of the Indian members had attempted to persuade Purshotamdas to vote for company management with the offer of the managing agency of the GIP Railway, whose term was to expire in 1924. It was a most tempting offer since it would yield a minimum of ₹7 lakhs a year over the next 20 or 30 years, to say nothing of the prestige, power, and patronage which accompanied such an appointment. Purshotamdas told the somewhat persistent member that his vote was not for sale and that he was not in favour of company management even if those companies were Indian.

In 1922, Purshotamdas was nominated to the Retrenchment Committee, headed by Lord Inchcape and entrusted with the task of suggesting ways to prune the mounting expenditure of the Central government. Purshotamdas's contributions to the Acworth Committee and the Inchcape Committee, and his work in many forums including the Bombay Legislative Assembly and the cotton industry, had done much to enhance his prestige in both the eyes of the government and the public. Recognition came in 1923 when he was conferred a knighthood for his services. He had already been bestowed a CIE in 1919 and a MBE before that. In the same year, more honour was in store, and he was nominated to the Council of State by the then Viceroy, Lord Reading. Purshotamdas, or Sir P.T. as he was fondly called, had arrived on the national stage after rendering outstanding service to his city and province.